

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

Some devastating news for Meenee!



### Learning Outcome

Relate information about common solutions to problems in spoken or written documents.

### Ask your partner:

- Do you own a pet? What kind?
- How often do you take it to the veterinarian?
- What happened the last time you were there?

### Can Do Statements

- I can write about reactions and behavior.
- I can quote other people in a written way.
- I can write about hypothetical situations about the past.

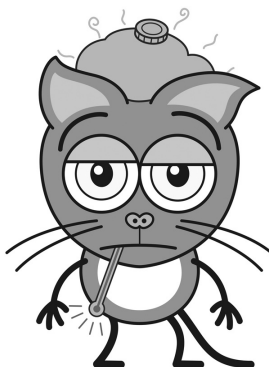




## Let's Explore!

Sally is given a tragic **prognosis\*** on her dear cat.

\* A "prognosis" is a medical term that means the likely outcome of a person's or animal's disease.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

- Sally:** Hey, where are you?  
**Vanessa:** I'm just leaving Starbucks, grabbed a cappuccino.  
**Sally:** If I had known that, I would have asked you to pick me up one, and a brownie too.  
**Vanessa:** Need a chocolate fix?  
**Sally:** Yeah ... I just got some upsetting news from the vet. I'm a bit of a mess.  
**Vanessa:** What? Is Meenee sick? You didn't tell me that.  
**Sally:** Well, I took him in for his yearly checkup. They told me they needed to draw some blood after a physical examination.  
**Vanessa:** And?  
**Sally:** They said that there are some grave concerns about his heart. They don't expect him to live through the winter.  
**Vanessa:** I'm so sorry to hear that. Did the vet suggest anything to improve his quality of life?  
**Sally:** The nurse said that there was very little I could do apart from keeping him comfortable.  
**Vanessa:** That would have been devastating to hear.  
**Sally:** I just feel so guilty. I should have recognized that there was a problem.  
**Vanessa:** Don't be ridiculous! You are a devoted pet owner. Meenee's your fur baby!  
**Sally:** I know but there were signs, now that I think of it. If I had spent more time with him, I might have seen that he was sleeping more than usual.  
**Vanessa:** Don't beat yourself up about it. You couldn't have been any more committed to him. He is now on medication, right?  
**Sally:** I just feel so lost. He's like a family member, you know?  
**Vanessa:** I understand. I'm turning around in the parking lot. Your cappuccino and brownie are on their way!



## Let's Practice!

The veterinary clinic makes a difficult call to Sally about her fur baby, Meenee.

*Instructions: Match the initial halves on the left to their corresponding ending halves on the right.*

- |                                          |                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1) They told me that they needed to draw | a) that there was very little I could do apart from keeping him comfortable. |
| 2) They said that there are some grave   | b) concerns about his heart.                                                 |
| 3) They don't expect                     | c) to improve his quality of life?                                           |
| 4) Did the vet suggest anything          | d) some blood after a physical examination.                                  |
| 5) The nurse said                        | e) him to live through the winter.                                           |



## Let's Practice!

Dealing with a sick or injured pet can be difficult. Imagine you have just received a phone call from the veterinarian\* to say that your pet is seriously ill. What is their diagnosis?\*

\*A "veterinarian" is a person who practices medicine on animals.

\*\*A "diagnosis" is the identification of a disease through examination.

*Instructions: Write a 150-170 word diary entry about the phone call and your reaction to the news.*

*Include the date and greeting Dear Diary,*

*Describe your pet. Is it a dog? Bird? Horse?*

*Write about why you took your pet to a veterinary surgery. What symptoms did it have?*

*What does the staff say? What is their diagnosis? Quote the veterinarian in a written way*

*Example:*

*She said that they could give him some medication for the pain.*

*What was your reaction to the news? Were you devastated?*

*Write three sentences about hypothetical situations in the past.*

*Examples:*

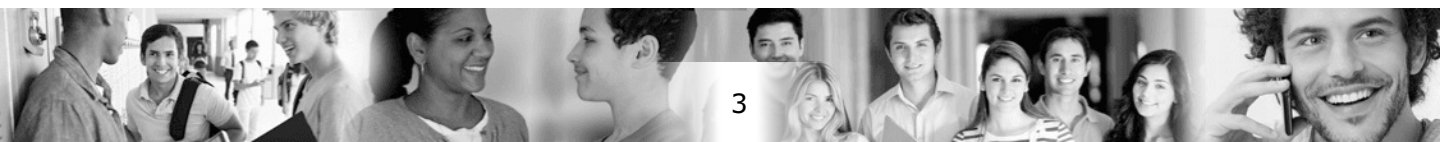
*If I had spent more time with him, I might have seen that he was sleeping more than usual.*

*If I had known that, I would have asked you to pick me up one, and a brownie too.*

*Did you call anyone?*

*Example: I immediately called my best friend.*

*What are the next steps? What do you plan to do in the future?*





## Extension Activity

Report a friend's offer of help.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Work in a group of three.
- Student 1 will briefly talk about a problem he or she has.
- Student 2 will talk about what he or she will do to help.
- Student 3 will tell student 1 what student 2 said, using reported speech.
- Change roles.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about reactions and behavior.

☐ ☐

I use reported speech in my writing.

☐ ☐

I write about hypothetical situations about the past.

☐ ☐

I talk about a problem, give advice and report on someone else's advice.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- fix** (noun): dose or amount to satisfy a craving  
e.g. Need a chocolate fix?
- to draw** (verb): to take or pull out  
e.g. They told me they needed to draw some blood.
- grave** (adjective): very serious; requiring or causing serious thought or concern  
e.g. I have some grave concerns about my dog's health.
- quality of life** (noun): the standard of health, comfort, and happiness in one's life  
e.g. Did the vet suggest anything to improve his quality of life?
- devoted** (adjective): having strong love or loyalty for something or someone  
e.g. You are a devoted pet owner.
- beat oneself up** (expression): to be overly critical of oneself  
e.g. Don't beat yourself up about it.
- fur baby** (expression): name given to pets that are treated like children  
e.g. Meenees is my fur baby.





## Learning Points

### Talking Hypothetically About the Past

You can use sentences with *if* to talk hypothetically about the past.

You use the Past Perfect form of the *if*-clause and a past modal in the main clause.

If + Past Perfect + Past modal

*would have, could have, might have*

Note: People often say *If I would have* instead of *If I had*, but this is not correct in writing.

#### Examples:

- *You should have told her about that important matter.*
- *If I had spent more time with him, I might have seen that he was sleeping more than usual.*
- *If I had known that, I would have asked you to pick me up one, and a brownie too.*





## Learning Points

### Reported Speech and Questions

You use a reporting verb like *to say* or *to tell* about what someone said in a conversation.

For example: *She said (that) my cat needed some additional tests.*

Reported questions are one form of reported speech.

You usually introduce reported questions with the verb *to ask*.

Here are some examples:

The vet **asked** (me) **if/whether...** (YES/NO questions)

The nurse **asked** (me) **why/when/where/what/how...** (question-word questions)

You may need to change pronouns and tense as well as time and place in reported questions.

The word order is like that of a normal statement (subject-verb-object).

| Tense                    | Direct Speech                                            | Reported Speech                                                           |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Present Simple tense     | <i>I love my cat, Meenee.</i>                            | <i>She said (that) she loved her cat, Meenee.</i>                         |
| Present Continuous tense | <i>I am living in the same apartment.</i>                | <i>She said (that) she was living in the same apartment.</i>              |
| Past Simple tense        | <i>I bought a new collar for my cat.</i>                 | <i>Sally said (that) she had bought a new collar for her cat.</i>         |
| Past Continuous tense    | <i>I was playing in the backyard with my cat.</i>        | <i>She said (that) she had been playing in her backyard with her cat.</i> |
| Present Perfect tense    | <i>I haven't seen that other cat across the hallway.</i> | <i>She said (that) she hadn't seen that other cat across the hallway.</i> |

### Examples:

- *The nurse asked me what I was feeding him.*
- *The vet asked me if they could keep Meenee overnight.*
- *The veterinarian told me that my beloved cat was very sick.*

